

of concepts, it primarily means that the design is inclusive, catering to the needs of people of all shapes and sizes. Tata also introduced distinct design changes for the Curvv EV. It features a streamlined design with smooth lines and a sloping roofline, enhancing aerodynamic efficiency to maximise range and reduce energy consumption. The mostly closed front grille, unlike in ICE vehicles, further improves aerodynamics and gives the EV a futuristic, minimalist look. Unique badging, accent colours, and aerodynamic wheels highlight its electric nature, while the absence of a traditional engine allows for additional storage space in the front trunk, or 'frunk,' optimising vehicle space.

The new ATLAS platform

The Tata Curvv sits on the brand new ATLAS platform, which is short for Adaptive Tech Forward Lifestyle Architecture. Along with new features, the ATLAS platform also comes with new speculations, such as its potential



to underpin all future SUVs from the company. It seems rather premature because apart from Nexon, the Tata Safari and Harrier already have newer or relatively new platforms that work more than fine. And as for the smaller SUV like the Tata Punch, I don't think a premium platform would even make sense to begin with.

But one thing is certain, Tata will launch new vehicles with the new ATLAS platform in the coming years. The ATLAS platform emphasises crashworthiness with a continuous framework that evenly distributes impact loads, ensuring uniform safety.

It is also highly adaptable, supporting various body styles and powertrain options, including petrol, diesel, and electric engines.

In line with the industry's shift towards software-driven vehicles, the ATLAS platform is designed to accommodate future technologies, incorporating advanced electric architecture and cloud platform capabilities. The CURVV, the first model to utilise ATLAS, will feature technology like an integrated cockpit-to-wheel controller, multiple displays, and over 24 Powertrain Control Units (PCUs), showcasing the platform's ability to support complex and advanced automotive systems.

New engines and battery

Alongside the Curvv Coupe SUV, Tata also took the liberty to debut its two new engines – a 1.2-litre Hyperion GDI Petrol and a 1.5-litre Kryojet Diesel engine. Moreover, these new engines will be paired with a Dual-channel automatic or a reworked manual gearbox. What's interesting is that Tata Motors has now become the only manufacturer in its segment to offer a Diesel engine + DCA gearbox combination. The older 1.2-liter Revotron engine is available with the Smart and Pure+S variants of the Tata Curvv.

As for the features, the Hyperion engine uses GDI (Gasoline Direct Injection) technology, which injects fuel directly into the combustion chamber, rather than mixing it with air beforehand. Tata claims that this results in better fuel atomisation, leading to more efficient combustion, improved power output, and reduced emissions.

The Hyperion engine's 3-cylinder unit is designed to be compact and



lightweight, which not only helps in reducing the overall weight but Tata is hoping that it'd further improve fuel efficiency too. The engine is constructed with materials that offer better heat management and reduce wear and tear on key components. Although vibrations and noise are common concerns with diesel engines.

The Curvv.ev, meanwhile, comes with strong numbers, but Tata has also provided a realistic minimum range, assuring customers of around 400 km on a full charge. This represents one of the worst-case scenarios, though the range could drop even further if the EV is driven more aggressively.

A Curvv ball to the competition

Following the launch of the Tata Curvv SUV Coupe, the brand appears more aggressive than ever. The introductory price for the Tata Curvv.ev starts at ₹17.49 lakh (ex-showroom), on par with many petrol automatic SUVs in the country. The ICE variants are also expected to be competitively priced, with announcements likely in early September. Moreover, Tata's advancements in battery and engine technology, design, and vehicle architecture position the brand ahead of most others in the country. Furthermore, the technology introduced in the Curvv SUV Coupe will eventually trickle down to other products in Tata's portfolio, effectively refreshing a significant portion of its lineup and making it even more competitive.

At this point, there's no doubt that Tata is poised to sell a lot of vehicles. The only hurdle remaining is for Tata Motors to provide consistent quality after-sales support, which has historically been a challenge for the rapidly growing brand. With an ever-expanding and impressive product portfolio, the only thing keeping Tata from claiming the top spot is improved after-sales service. If they can master that, they'll truly be unstoppable—ready to take on the world with all their ducks in a row. **d**